-- quick guide · 10 commands

SQL

SQL explained for beginners.

Ten keywords that handle **90% of your day** with databases.

scan for
the full source

-- 01 · read data

SELECT

Pick which columns you want.

Ask a table for the columns you need.
`*` means **all of them**.

select.sql

```
-- all columns
SELECT * FROM users;
-- only the ones you need
SELECT name, email FROM users;
```

-- 02 · filter rows

WHERE

Keep only the rows that match.

Like a search box inside the table: **filter** and keep just what you care about.

where.sql

```
SELECT * FROM users
WHERE age ≥ 18
  AND country = 'MX';
```

-- 03 · sort

ORDER BY

Sort the result your way.

Ascending by default; add `DESC` for **highest first**.

order.sql

```sql
SELECT name, age FROM users
ORDER BY age DESC;
```

-- 04 · cap rows

LIMIT

Ask for **just a few** rows.

Perfect for **top-N** lists and fast table previews.

limit.sql

```sql
SELECT * FROM users
ORDER BY created_at DESC
LIMIT 10;
```

-- 05 · combine tables

JOIN

Glue two tables by a **shared column.**

Data lives split (users, orders). JOIN connects them by a key, like `user_id`.

join.sql

```sql
SELECT u.name, o.total
FROM users u
JOIN orders o
  ON o.user_id = u.id;
```

-- 06 · aggregate

GROUP BY

Collapse rows into **one per group.**

Pair it with `COUNT`, `SUM` or `AVG` to **summarize** your data.

group.sql

```
SELECT country, COUNT(*)
FROM users
GROUP BY country;
```

-- 07 · search text

LIKE

Match text by a **pattern.**

`%` is a wildcard: `'A%'` means **starts with A**.

like.sql

```sql
SELECT * FROM users
WHERE name LIKE 'A%';
```

-- 08 · add data

INSERT

Add a new row to a table.

List the columns, then the **values** that fill them.

insert.sql

```sql
INSERT INTO users (name, age)
VALUES ('Ada', 36);
```

-- 09 · change data

UPDATE

Edit rows that **already exist.**

No `WHERE` means you change **every row**. Never forget it.

update.sql

```sql
UPDATE users
SET age = 37
WHERE id = 1;
```

-- 10 · remove data

DELETE

Remove rows you no longer need.

Same rule: no `WHERE`, and the **whole table** is gone.

delete.sql

```sql
DELETE FROM users
WHERE id = 1;
```

`-- that's the 90%`

You just learned the **core of SQL.**

Master these ten and you can query almost any database. Which one do you reach for most?

Alejandro Sánchez Yalí
Software Developer | AI & Blockchain Enthusiast
www.asanchezyali.com

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